

LET ME TRY · FREE PRINTABLE

The Calm Morning Checklist

For smoother school and daycare mornings · Ages 2–4

Most morning battles are planned the night before. A little preparation and a slower start make the whole day easier for everyone.

The night before

- ○ Two outfits laid out (they choose one in the morning)
- ○ Bag packed and by the door
- ○ Shoes and water bottle ready
- ○ Breakfast planned

In the morning

- ○ Wake up 15 minutes before your child
- ○ 5 minutes of cuddles before anything else
- ○ Picture cards for the steps: toilet, wash, dress, eat, shoes
- ○ Give 5-minute warnings before leaving
- ○ Let them do what they can themselves

Phrases that help

- ○ “First shoes, then we go see the birds.”
- ○ “Do you want to hop or tiptoe to the door?”
- ○ “Let's race the timer!”

On hard mornings

Lower the bar. Mismatched socks and a quick breakfast are fine. Connection matters more than perfection.

SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

General guidance based on Montessori principles of independence and routine.